

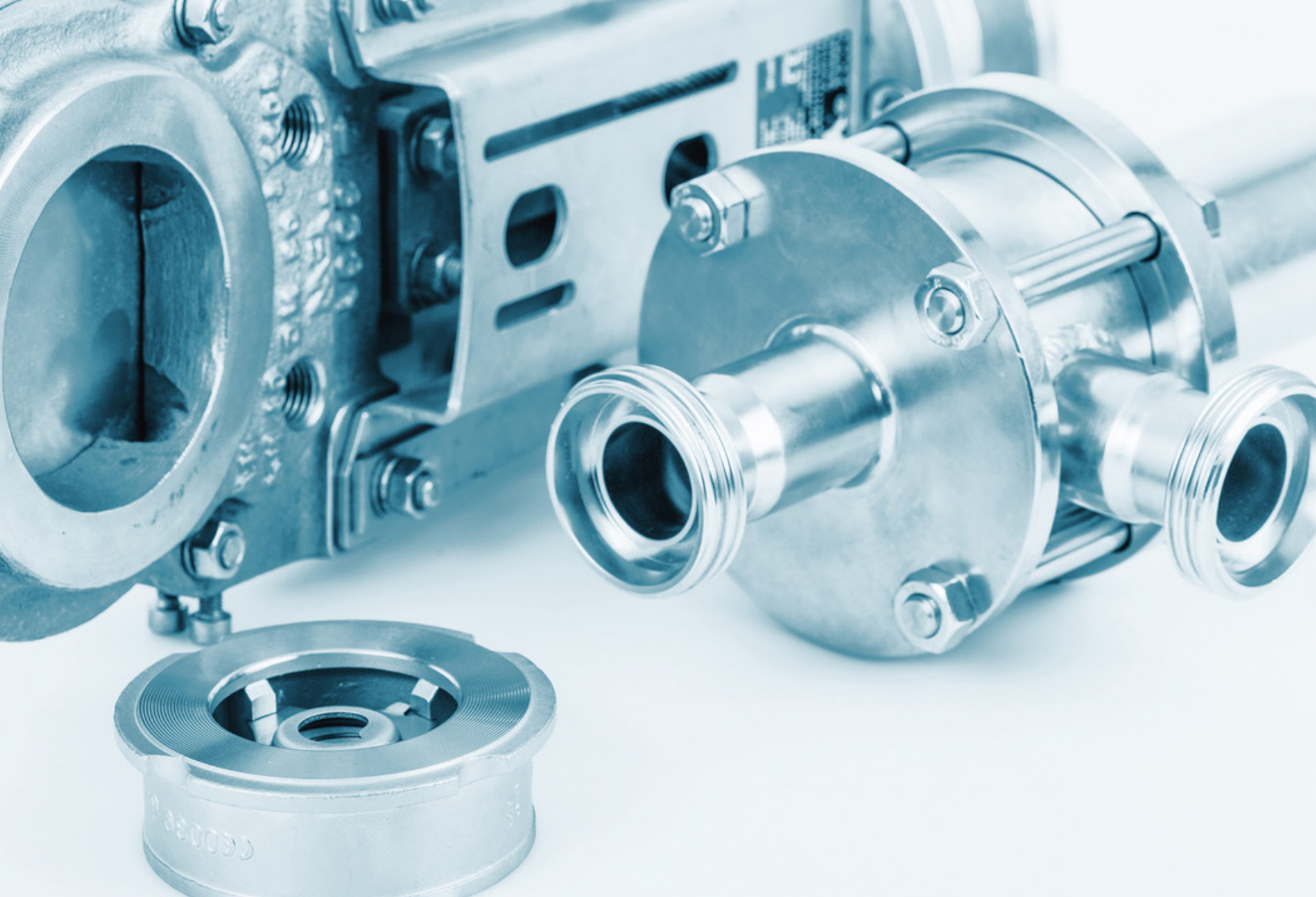


Mastering Valve Selection

A Comprehensive eBook for
Choosing the Perfect Valve
Type for Your Application

Table of Contents

3	Introduction
5	Valve Basics and Functionality
8	Factors Influencing Valve Type Selection
10	Common Valve Types and Their Applications
13	Valve Selection Guidelines for Specific Industries
15	Valve Features and Performance Factors
17	Evaluating Valve Manufacturers and Suppliers
18	Valve Installation, Operation and Maintenance
19	Final Thoughts
20	Appendix



Introduction

When it comes to industrial applications, selecting the right valve is key. Whether you're an experienced professional or new to the industry, it's helpful to understand the importance of valve selection. The right choice can enhance system efficiency, extend the application's lifespan and streamline maintenance processes. In contrast, a poor choice can lead to inefficiency, system failures and high maintenance costs.

Understanding the Role of Valve Types in Various Applications

You'll find valves across different industries, each with a unique set of requirements and operating conditions. The oil and gas sector, water treatment plants, chemical industries and HVAC systems all use specific valve types to ensure smooth and efficient operations. Knowing about these roles can contribute to operational success and lay the groundwork for cost and energy-efficient systems.

Key Considerations for Optimal Valve Selection

Aside from understanding valve roles and functions, there are specific operational factors that play a crucial role in valve selection. These include:

- **System Pressure Requirements:** The selected valve must operate effectively within the required pressure ranges.
- **Temperature Conditions:** The material and design of the valve must be compatible with the temperature conditions.
- **Flow Requirements:** The valve size and type must meet the system's flow requirements, providing efficient fluid flow control.
- **Cycle Frequency:** The number of times a valve is opened and closed has a direct impact on its lifespan.

Overlooking any of these factors could lead to suboptimal performance, system inefficiencies and premature wear and tear on your valve, potentially escalating to system failure.

In the subsequent chapters, we'll delve deeper into these aspects, equipping you with the knowledge to make informed valve selection decisions.



Valve Basics and Functionality

Industrial Valves: Their Core Functions and Operational Principles

Valves are crucial for managing and directing fluid flow in the industrial landscape. Your choice among various valve types depends on their unique features and your system's specific requirements. Here's a quick look at **common valve types**:



Globe Valves - are good for throttling and precise control applications.

Ball Valves - are quarter-turn valves known for reliable sealing, fast cycle times and simple operation.

Butterfly Valves - are a cost-effective quarter-turn valve favored in low-cycle, low-risk applications.

Gate Valves - are low-cost valves mostly used for on-off control with limited pressure drop.

Check Valves - are designed to prevent the reverse flow of fluids.

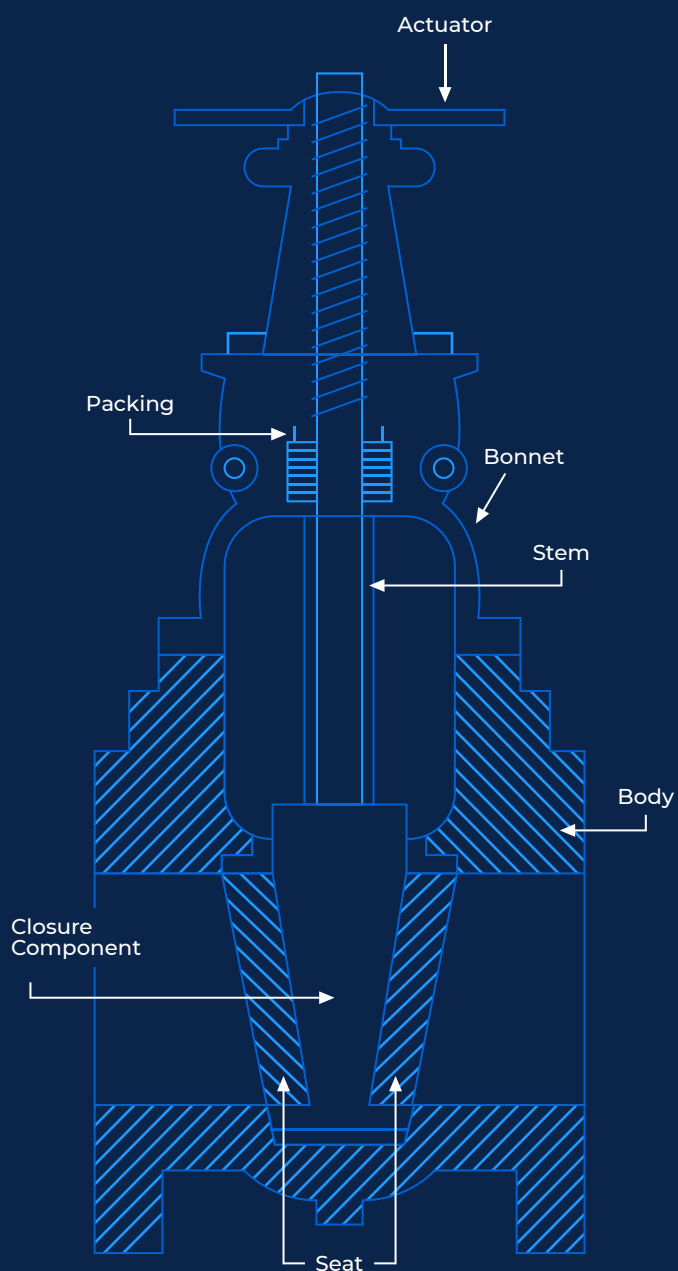
Pressure Release Valves - protect systems from overpressure situations.

Diaphragm Valves - are used in sanitary applications due to their specific design.

Plug Valves - are often used for on-off control and to minimize fluid trapping.

Gate Valves  Gate  Manual OperatedP  pneumatic  MotorH  ydraulic  Bleeder		
Globe Valves  Globe  Pneumatic  Motor  Hydraulic  Angle  Pneumatic  Motor  Needle		
Ball Valves    Motor or Hydraulic	Plug Valves    Motor or Hydraulic	
Butterfly Valves   	    Pneumatic Operated Solenoid Closed Three-Way	
Diaphragm Valves  DiaphragmM   otor	Check Valves  Check ValveS  Check Valve  top Check	
Safety (Gases)  	Relief (Liquids) 	 PinchG  ague  OriPce

Valve Body & Basic Parts



This is an example using a Gate Valve and is not a representation of all styles of valves.

Beyond their types and roles, it's worthwhile to understand the internal workings of these different styles of valves. These complex devices comprise several key parts, each significant in ensuring the valve operates effectively and efficiently. Here's a breakdown of the main components and their functions:

- **Body:** The primary external housing of the valve components
- **Bonnet:** Provides a secure, leak-proof closure for the valve body*
- **Trim:** Comprises various components such as the stem, closure component, and any other hardware used for the specific valve style
- **Actuator:** Responsible for initiating and controlling the opening and closing of the valve, either manually or automatically
- **Packing/Seals:** The components used to create a tight seal within the valve, ensuring no leaks.
- **Seat:** Interacts with the disc to form a seal, halting flow when the valve is closed

Use the image to help identify the various parts of a valve

**Note that not all styles of valves include a bonnet in the design*

Factors Influencing Valve Type Selection

5 Considerations to Account For When Choosing a Valve

Choosing the right valve requires a thorough understanding of various key factors. The decision-making process includes considerations from fluid compatibility and pressure requirements to environmental and application-specific needs. Let's examine each of these factors in more detail.



Fluid Compatibility and Chemical Resistance:

The nature of the fluid flowing through the valve is crucial in valve selection. Factors such as pH level, viscosity and corrosiveness can impact the durability and function of the valve. It's vital to understand the interaction between the fluid and the valve material to ensure compatibility and longevity.

Pressure and Temperature Requirements:

The operational pressure and temperature within the system play a significant role in valve performance. Both the maximum and minimum pressure and temperature levels that the valve will experience must be considered. Variations in these factors can impact the valve's efficiency and overall life expectancy.



Flow Control and Regulation Needs:

Flow control requirements are key to valve selection. Based on the application, the necessary flow rate and flow path will vary. Different valve types offer differing levels of flow control capabilities, and the selection must align with the system's specific needs.

Environmental and Safety Considerations:

Valve operations can have environmental implications, and these must be factored into the decision process. Additionally, safety is of the utmost importance, and all chosen components must comply with existing safety regulations and standards.

Industry and Application-Specific Requirements:

Specific industries have unique regulations and guidelines to adhere to when choosing a valve. In addition, the valve's intended application may necessitate certain features such as high cleanliness standards, exceptional reliability or enhanced durability. Evaluating these application-specific factors is an essential part of the selection process.

Common Valve Types and Their Applications

Navigating the Landscape of Frequently Used Valves

The wide range of valve types caters to unique functionalities, applications and specific advantages. The choice of a particular valve depends significantly on system requirements, including pressure, flow control and compatibility with the involved fluids or gasses. Let's dive into the characteristics of several common valve types.



Globe Valves

These valves stand out when precise throttling and regulation are needed. They are uniquely designed to handle conditions with high pressure drops, making them ideal for applications where flow needs to be adjusted or stopped frequently.



Ball Valves

Ball valves are lauded for their excellent sealing capability, providing a long-lasting, leak-proof system when in the "off" position. These valves feature fast cycle times and are typically favored in on/off applications but can also be used as control valves when fitted with a v-port ball. Ball valves also outlast many other valve types when used with media that contains particulates.



Gate Valves

Gate valves are the go-to option for applications that require an unobstructed flow path, resulting in very low pressure loss. However, they are not suited for throttling applications, as the high flow velocity can cause disk and seat wear. These valves also take longer to cycle than quarter-turn valves such as butterfly valves or ball valves.



Butterfly Valves

For applications that handle large flow rates, butterfly valves offer an efficient solution. They are compact, lighter in weight and less expensive than other valves. However, they are less effective when a tight seal is required, particularly in high-pressure scenarios.



Check Valves

Check valves are preventive mechanisms that keep systems safe by preventing backflow. They allow fluid to flow in one direction and close automatically if the fluid reverses, requiring minimal maintenance.



Pressure Relief Valves

Pressure relief valves protect systems from exceeding pressure limits, making them a vital safety component in many industries. They work by releasing excess pressure when the system's pressure approaches a preset limit.



Diaphragm Valves

In applications where cleanliness is paramount, diaphragm valves are often the best choice. They offer superior isolation and are popular in the food, beverage and pharmaceutical industries. However, they aren't suitable for high-temperature applications.



Plug Valves

Plug valves are reliable for achieving a secure shut-off and maintaining a low-pressure drop. They are ideal for on-off control applications but are not suitable for throttling due to potential erosion of the plug and seat.

The following table provides a quick reference of these valve types:

Valve Type	Key Characteristics	Best Use Cases
Globe	Precise control or throttling, high-pressure drops	Precise flow control applications
Ball	Excellent sealing, versatile	On-off and control applications
Gate	Unobstructed flow, not for throttling	Applications needing free flow and low cost
Butterfly	Large flow rates, not tight sealing	Applications requiring on-off control and high flow rates
Check	Prevents backflow, low maintenance	Systems where the prevention of backflow is critical
Pressure Relief	Protects against excess pressure	Safety critical systems
Diaphragm	Clean operation, not for high-temperature	Sanitary applications
Plug	Reliable shut-off, low pressure drop	On-off and control applications

Valve Selection Guidelines for Specific Industries

Tailoring Valve Choice to Industry Needs

Valve selection goes beyond understanding the types and functionality of different valves. Specific industry requirements, safety standards, operational conditions and environmental considerations also play a pivotal role in deciding the appropriate valve type. Below, we examine some key industries and provide guidelines for valves that cater to their specific needs.



Oil & Gas

In this sector, valves must handle high pressures and temperatures. Given the corrosive nature of some fluids, valves made of corrosion-resistant materials are favored.

Chemical & Petrochemical

Chemical resistance is paramount, as valves often come into contact with aggressive and corrosive chemicals. Equally important are safety considerations due to the potential hazards associated with chemical reactions.

Water & Wastewater

Valves in these systems need to handle large flow rates. Longevity and reliability are also significant considerations due to the critical nature of water and wastewater services.



HVAC & Plumbing Systems

In these systems, valves should prioritize efficiency and noise reduction to ensure optimal system performance and compliance with building codes.

Pharmaceutical and Food Processing

Valves used in these industries must meet stringent sanitation standards. They often require special materials that are resistant to aggressive cleaning agents and can maintain their integrity in various temperature ranges.

Power Generation

Valves in power generation need to be capable of handling high temperatures and pressures. Due to the critical role of these systems, valves require regular maintenance and inspection to ensure system safety and efficiency.

Mining & Minerals

Given the harsh operating conditions, valves must be robust and durable. They often require special materials that offer corrosion and abrasion resistance to handle the challenging environment.

Pulp & Paper

Valves in this industry must handle abrasive and corrosive materials. Durability and easy maintenance are also significant due to the continuous and demanding production processes.

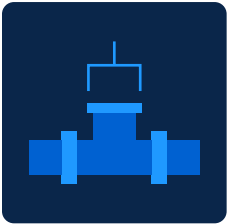
Marine & Shipbuilding

In marine environments, valves must resist saltwater corrosion. Safety considerations are also paramount due to the potential risk in these settings.

Valve Features and Performance Factors

Evaluating Valve Characteristics for Optimal Performance

Valves, like any piece of equipment, come with various features, are available in a wide variety of styles and designs that determine their overall performance and suitability for a particular application. This section assesses critical valve characteristics, including size, material, sealing mechanisms, actuation methods and others. Understanding these elements can lead to more informed decisions when selecting valves for a specific task or environment.



Valve Size and Flow Capacity

Larger valves typically allow for greater flow rates. However, different styles of valves have different port sizes and flow paths, both of which are critical factors when determining flow rate. It is also critical to understand that valves are only one of many factors that impact the overall flow of a piping system.



Material Selection and Corrosion Resistance

Materials for valves should be chosen based on fluid properties. Certain materials offer better resistance to corrosion, which is crucial when valves handle corrosive fluids.



Sealing Mechanisms and Leakage Prevention

Different sealing methods offer varying degrees of tightness, reliability and longevity. Proper sealing is critical as leakage can lead to efficiency loss and pose potential safety hazards.



Noise and Vibration Control

Excessive noise and vibration from valves and actuators can indicate underlying issues and lead to premature wear and tear. Some valve designs are better at reducing noise and vibration, contributing to longer valve life and smoother operation.



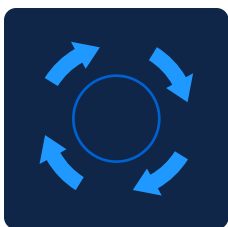
Actuation Methods and Automation Options

Manual actuation is simpler and less expensive but requires physical operation. On the other hand, automatic actuation, although more expensive, offers enhanced control and requires less manpower. Actuation is typically favored in high-cycle applications where manual operation would not be practical, or in applications where the valve is not easily accessible to operate.



Maintenance and Serviceability Factors

Valves that are easily accessible for servicing can reduce downtime and contribute to operational efficiency. Some valve types require frequent maintenance whereas others may not require any at all and should be replaced rather than repaired. Be sure to ask the valve manufacturer for the best maintenance practices for your specific valve.



Lifecycle Costs and Total Cost of Ownership

The total cost of valve ownership includes those associated with the initial investment, operational costs, maintenance and potential downtime. A low-cost valve may seem attractive initially but may end up costing more in the long run if it requires frequent maintenance or replacement.



Evaluating Valve Manufacturers and Suppliers

Key Criteria for Choosing a Reliable Valve Supplier

Choosing the right valve manufacturer or supplier plays a critical role in ensuring the performance, reliability and durability of valves in your system. Here, we outline the essential criteria for assessing valve manufacturers and suppliers, including their reputation, quality assurance, support services and pricing.



1. Assessing Manufacturer Reputation and Experience

Indicators of reliability can include years in business, customer reviews and industry recognition. Manufacturers with expertise in specific types of valves or industries can offer a significant advantage.

2. Quality Assurance and Certification Standards

Reliable manufacturers should hold industry-standard certifications and have robust quality control processes, indicating a commitment to product reliability and consistent performance.

3. Customization and Engineering Support

A manufacturer's ability to customize valves for specific applications can be crucial. Additionally, engineering support can aid in selecting the right valve and facilitate seamless installation.

4. After-Sales Service and Technical Assistance

Strong after-sales service can minimize downtime and maintenance costs, while technical assistance can be invaluable in troubleshooting and ongoing maintenance.

5. Price and Delivery Considerations

The challenge often lies in balancing cost with quality and service. Furthermore, manufacturers' delivery times can significantly impact project timelines, making this an essential factor to consider.

Valve Installation, Operation and Maintenance

Best Practices for Ensuring Optimal Valve Performance

Valve performance is closely tied to how well it is installed, operated and maintained. This chapter outlines best practices for valve installation, start-up procedures, routine maintenance, troubleshooting and considerations for repair or replacement.



Proper Valve Installation Guidelines

Ensuring correct valve installation is crucial as it can prevent inefficiencies and potential damage. Critical aspects include correct alignment, proper support and effective sealing.

Start-Up & Commissioning Procedures

Starting up the valve correctly is key to ensuring optimal operation. Commissioning is equally important as it validates both the installation and operation of the valve.

Routine Maintenance & Inspection Practices

Regular inspection of valves can help detect potential issues early. Maintenance schedules often depend on the valve type and its usage.

Troubleshooting Common Valve Issues

A good understanding of common valve issues can expedite problem resolution. Certain issues may be resolved without the need for professional assistance.

Repair & Replacement Considerations

Deciding whether to repair or replace a valve can be complex. Account for factors such as cost, potential downtime and expected future performance. Always consult the manufacturer before attempting to repair an existing valve.



CONCLUSION

Valve Selection: Final Thoughts

Applying Insights for Effective Decision Making

Understanding the dynamics of valve technology and staying informed about the latest trends are fundamental to making effective valve selection decisions. Let's recap the salient points and look toward the future of this complex field:

Key Principles of Valve Selection: Choosing the optimal valve requires a clear comprehension of the application details as well as the different valve styles and features available. Remember, understanding fluid properties, operational requirements, environmental considerations and industry standards are all critical to the longevity and performance of your valve systems.

Emerging Trends: Stay ahead by being aware of the evolving trends shaping valve technology:

- Digital technology integration for advanced valve control and monitoring.
- Material science advancements providing enhanced durability and efficiency.
- Increasing focus on sustainability in valve manufacturing and operation.

Collaboration with Experts: Partnering with valve manufacturers can enhance your understanding, improve decision making and provide professional assistance throughout selection, installation and maintenance. This collaboration is key to creating efficient, reliable and custom systems that are unique to your needs.

Mastering the process of valve selection requires continuous learning, effective collaboration and adaptability. Applying these principles dynamically, in collaboration with experts and with a keen eye on future trends, is the path to successful valve-related operations.

Do you need more insights or assistance with your valve selection process? We're ready to add value to your operations. Share your project details with us and let's get started.

Contact Us

Appendix

Glossary of Valve Terminology

Cavitation: A damaging condition that occurs when vapor bubbles form in a liquid due to changes in pressure and then suddenly collapse.

Characteristic Curve: A graphical representation of a valve's flow characteristics. It describes the relationship between the flow rate and the valve opening for a given set of pressure conditions.

Direct Acting: A type of valve where the closure element is directly affected by the actuating energy.

Fail-closed: A term used to describe a valve that in its de-energized state, will close.

Fail-open: A term used to describe a valve that in its de-energized state, will open.

Flow coefficient (Cv): A measure that indicates the amount of fluid (in gallons) that will flow through a valve in one minute with a 1 psi pressure drop.

Hysteresis: The difference in output response when the input changes in one direction compared to the opposite direction. In valve terms, this refers to the change in position of a valve for the same control signal, depending on whether the valve is opening or closing.

Interlock: A device to prevent a valve from being operated when it could result in an unsafe condition.

Rated Pressure (or pressure rating): The maximum pressure at which a valve can safely operate.

Valve Authority: A measure of how dominant a valve's control is in a system. A valve with high authority has more control over the flow rate.

Valve Signature: A graphical representation of the performance characteristics of a control valve assembly. It plots the input signal to the actuator versus the stem position.

Water Hammer: A pressure surge caused when a fluid in motion is forced to stop or change direction suddenly.

Conversion Tables and Useful Formulas

Pressure Conversion: To convert pressure from PSI to Bar, multiply by 0.06895. To convert from Bar to PSI, multiply by 14.503.

Flow Rate Conversion: To convert from Cubic Meters per Hour (m³/h) to Gallons per Minute (GPM), multiply by 4.40287.

Temperature Conversion: To convert from Fahrenheit to Celsius, subtract 32 and multiply by 0.5556. To convert from Celsius to Fahrenheit, multiply by 1.8 and add 32.

[Check out our Flow Rate & CV Calculator for Valve Sizing](#)

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

How does a valve work? A valve controls the flow of a fluid (gasses, liquids, fluidized solids or slurries) by opening, closing or partially obstructing various passageways.

How do I know which valve to use? The choice of a valve depends on the specific requirements of the system, such as fluid type, pressure and flow control needs and the specific application.

How often should valves be serviced or replaced? The frequency of valve servicing or replacement depends on the operational conditions, the type of media and the specific valve type. Regular inspection and preventive maintenance are recommended to ensure optimal valve performance. Reach out to the manufacturer directly for the best practices for maintaining your specific valve.

Can one type of valve be used for all applications? No, different types of valves are designed to perform specific functions and cater to unique operational conditions. Selecting the right valve depends on several factors including fluid type, pressure and temperature conditions, flow control needs and industry-specific requirements.

Reccomended Resources

[Your Complete Guide To Valve Actuators](#)
[A Guide to Ball Valve Maintenance](#)

[NSF Valve Certifications: NSF 61 vs NSF 372](#)
[Ball Valve Dimensions Explained](#)